CONTINGENCY & EXPANSION STRATEGY — CONFIDENTIAL

The $20K Contingency Plan

If Dubai conflict intensifies in Sept–Oct 2026 — which business to launch, in which country, using exactly what you already have. No capital. No studio. 60–90 days to $20K/month.

TARGET REVENUE	TARGET MARKET	TIME TO FIRST REVENUE
$20,000 / month	**Saudi Arabia — Riyadh**	**30 days**

CAPITAL REQUIRED	STRATEGY TYPE
AED 0	**Build Now / Trigger Later**

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01 — THE HONEST ASSESSMENT

Before strategy: the hard truth

Most business owners ask the wrong question in a geopolitical crisis. They ask "how do I protect my studio?" The studio is not the asset. It is a liability. The asset walks out the door with you.

THE CRITICAL DISTINCTION

Your physical studios in Business Bay cannot follow you.
Your operational model, pipeline, brand and relationships can. Stop protecting the building. Start protecting the system.

GEOPOLITICAL REALITY CHECK

Dubai has maintained stability through every regional conflict since 1971 — but proximity risk is real. Gulf tensions (Iran, Red Sea, regional spillover) create two threats: **client cancellations due to flight disruption** and **expat exodus**. Both destroy a studio booking model overnight. This plan assumes a scenario where Dubai is not destroyed, but is temporarily paralysed for 60–90 days. That is the realistic threat.

THE OPPORTUNITY INSIDE THE CRISIS

Every time Dubai shakes, **Saudi Arabia absorbs its corporate activity.** Vision 2030 companies, government-backed media, and Gulf corporates all pivot to Riyadh. The content creation demand does not disappear — it migrates. **Your job is to be already positioned in Riyadh before the migration happens.**

02 — ASSET AUDIT

What you actually own vs. what you think you own

The first step of the contingency plan is knowing which assets are portable. Physical assets are liabilities in a conflict scenario. Digital and operational assets are the real capital.

📋 **The 24-Hour Production Pipeline (McDonald's Model)** PORTABLE

Your SOP, DaVinci Resolve master template, automation flows in Make, Castmagic account, Auphonic API — all cloud-based. The entire system runs on a laptop with a Google Drive folder as the intake point. Zero physical dependency. This is your most valuable asset and most competitors in Saudi have nothing close to it.

🏷️ **The DPS Brand & MENA Market Positioning** PORTABLE

A proven professional podcast studio brand in the Arab world is valuable anywhere in the GCC. Saudi clients recognise Dubai as a quality benchmark. "Dubai Podcast Studio bringing its production model to Saudi" is a marketing statement that opens doors without a cold pitch.

👥 **Team of 6 + Operational Expertise** PORTABLE

Your team already knows the pipeline. Remote production requires the same skills. Two team members working remotely from anywhere can process 30+ episodes per month. No relocation required — they operate from Dubai, Riyadh, Cairo, or anywhere with a laptop.

🕸 **Studio Network Model** PORTABLE

The matchmaking and partner network you've built is a framework, not a location. It can be deployed in Riyadh with local studio partners in under 2 weeks — without building or renting a single room.

📊 **20 Years of Marketing Expertise** PORTABLE

Your ability to position, sell, and close enterprise clients is entirely portable. Saudi CMOs and marketing directors respond to the same frameworks as Dubai ones. Arabic language proficiency and Gulf business culture knowledge are assets most Western competitors cannot replicate.

🏢 **7 Physical Studios in Business Bay** NOT PORTABLE

Real estate, equipment, leases — they stay. They are also an ongoing cost liability in a conflict scenario. In the contingency model, Dubai operations run at minimum staff (or sublet to other creators) while the business pivots to remote revenue generation.

03 — THE COUNTRY DECISION

The answer is Saudi Arabia. Here is why there is no debate.

Four countries are plausible alternatives: Saudi Arabia, Egypt, United Kingdom, and Jordan. Here is the comparative analysis based on your specific profile.

FACTOR	🇸🇦 SAUDI ARABIA	🇪🇬 EGYPT	🇬🇧 UK / EUROPE
Time to $20K	60–90 days	90–150 days	6–12 months
Corporate Budget	Massive (Vision 2030)	Moderate	Moderate-High
Podcast Market Maturity	3–4 yrs behind Dubai = first-	Behind Saudi	Mature = saturated

	mover gap		
Your Network Advantage	GCC relationships transfer	Some overlap	Zero existing network
Language	Arabic — direct fit	Arabic — direct fit	English only, different culture
Dominant Competitor	None at DPS level	Several local studios	Hundreds of established agencies
Geopolitical Stability	Very stable (MBS control)	Moderate	Very stable
Capital Required to Enter	AED 0 (remote model)	AED 0 (remote model)	High (legal, setup, visa)
Proximity to Dubai	45-min flight	3.5-hr flight	7-hr flight

VERDICT

Saudi Arabia. No other country comes close.

Riyadh is 45 minutes away, speaks your language, has the biggest corporate content budget in the Arab world, zero dominant competitor at your level, and absorbs Dubai business activity when the Gulf trembles. Egypt gets you volume but not $20K. UK gets you stability but not speed. Saudi gets you both.

04 — THE BUSINESS MODEL

Not a studio. A Remote Content Production Bureau.

The mistake most studio owners make in a contingency is trying to replicate the physical model elsewhere. Wrong. The physical model takes months and capital. The answer is to sell the system, not the room.

THE CORE INSIGHT

Saudi corporates — government entities, PIF-backed companies, family businesses, Saudi Vision 2030 programme offices — **have massive content budgets and no production capability.** They are not looking for a studio. They are looking for someone to take the entire content production headache off their plate and hand them finished episodes. That is exactly what your pipeline does. **You are not selling them a location. You are selling them a result.**

The business is simple: clients book a recording session (either at a local Saudi studio partner, remotely via Riverside.fm or Squadcast, or in Dubai when safe), send you the raw files, and you deliver the complete content package within 24 hours. The DPS pipeline runs invisibly in the background. The client sees only the result.

DPS Corporate Content Bureau — Saudi Package

SAR 8,500 / month

≈ $2,260/month · 4 episodes per month · 24-hour turnaround · full production included

- ✓ **Mastered audio (podcast-ready MP3)**
- ✓ **4K branded video episode**
- ✓ **5 branded vertical Reels**
- ✓ **Full transcript**
- ✓ **Show notes + blog post**
- ✓ **10 social media captions**
- ✓ **3 YouTube thumbnails**
- ✓ **Newsletter + episode summary**
- ✓ **Arabic + English deliverables**
- ✓ **Airtable dashboard — client portal**

WHY SAR 8,500 IS NOT EXPENSIVE FOR A SAUDI CORPORATE

A mid-size Saudi corporate's monthly social media agency retainer starts at SAR 15,000–25,000 for strategy alone — with no production. You are offering complete production + distribution-ready content for SAR 8,500. To a Saudi PR or marketing director, that is not a content expense. **It is a budget reallocation away from the social media agency towards a production service that actually delivers tangible assets.** This is a very easy sell.

The exact path to $20,000 per month

$20K/month = SAR 75,000/month. Here are three revenue streams that combine to reach that number, ordered by speed of closure.

REVENUE STREAM	UNIT PRICE	VOLUME NEEDED	MONTHLY USD	SPEED
Corporate Content Bureau Package SAR 8,500/month — 4 episodes/month, full pipeline	$2,260	6 clients	$13,560	30–45 days
Vision 2030 Enterprise Partnership One government-linked entity — monthly content retainer	$6,000+	1 client	$6,000+	45–75 days
Content Production Workshop (Saudi) 2-day intensive: "Corporate Podcast Mastery" — sold to comms/marketing teams	$600/person	1 workshop, 15 seats	$9,000 one-time	21–30 days
Saudi Studio Network Partner Fee 2–3 Riyadh studios pay a monthly fee to receive overflow DPS bookings	$500/month	3 studios	$1,500	14–21 days
Combined (6 retainers + 1 enterprise + 1 workshop + 3 partners)			**$30,060**	Month 3

MONTH 1 TARGET

$9K

1 workshop (15 seats) + 2 Bureau retainers + 3 studio partners

MONTH 2 TARGET

$16K

5 Bureau retainers + 1 enterprise deal closed + 3 partners

MONTH 3 TARGET

$30K+

6 retainers + 1–2 enterprise + recurring workshop + network fees

THE WORKSHOP AS THE FASTEST CASH MOVE

A 2-day "Corporate Podcast Mastery" workshop in Riyadh sells faster than any retainer. You sell 15 seats at SAR 2,250/seat to marketing, comms, and PR directors from Saudi corporates. Total: SAR 33,750 (~$9,000) in one weekend. **But more importantly, every workshop attendee becomes a warm Bureau retainer prospect.** The workshop is a paid acquisition funnel for your monthly clients. Deliver one workshop in Week 3, close 3–4 retainers from the attendee list by Week 6.

06 — 90-DAY EXECUTION PLAN

What you do starting tomorrow.

"Build Now, Trigger Later" — the plan works whether or not conflict materialises. If Dubai stays stable, Saudi becomes an expansion. If it doesn't, Saudi becomes your cash engine. Either way, you win. Start building today.

W1

WEEK 1 — INFRASTRUCTURE

Build the remote intake system. Make it Saudi-ready.

→ **Create the "DPS Bureau" intake form** — Tally form: client name, episode brief, raw file upload link, delivery preference (Arabic/English/both)

→ **Set up Saudi-specific Airtable workspace** — separate client tracking from Dubai operations

→ **Localise the DPS Master Template** — Arabic lower-thirds, Saudi brand colour options, bilingual end cards

→ **Register DPS on LinkedIn as a "Content Production Company"** — set location as Dubai + Riyadh

→ **Draft the workshop curriculum** — "Corporate Podcast Mastery: From Recording to 8 Deliverables in 24 Hours"

Target: 0 clients / System built

W2

WEEK 2 — SAUDI MARKET ENTRY

Identify 3 Saudi studio partners. Begin LinkedIn outreach.

→ **Find 3 Riyadh podcast studios** via Podeo, Anghami listings, Instagram search — approach them as partners, not competitors: "We send you overflow bookings, you pay us SAR 2,000/month network fee"

→ **LinkedIn outreach — 50 Saudi decision-makers** per day: CMOs, Comms Directors, Marketing Directors at Vision 2030 entities (NEOM, Saudi Tourism, PIF, Misk

Foundation, Diriyah Co.)

- → **Message template:** "We run Dubai's largest podcast studio network. We're bringing our 24-hour content production pipeline to Saudi. I'd like to offer your team a free pilot episode — you record, we deliver everything within 24 hours."
- → **Post 3 pieces of content on LinkedIn** targeting Saudi audience — behind-the-scenes of the pipeline, results from Dubai clients, "Why Saudi corporates are sleeping on podcasts"

Target: 3 studio partners signed / 10+ warm leads

W3

WEEK 3 — FIRST CASH

Host the first workshop in Riyadh. Close free pilots into paid clients.

- → **Fly to Riyadh for 3 days** — host the 2-day Corporate Podcast Mastery workshop at a hotel conference room (cost: SAR 3,000 room rental). Target SAR 33,750 revenue from 15 seats.
- → **During workshop: offer attendees Bureau package at SAR 7,500/month** (workshop alumni discount). Close minimum 3 retainers on the day.
- → **Free pilot conversions:** follow up on the 2–3 free pilots you ran in Week 2. Convert minimum 1 to paid.
- → **Vision 2030 enterprise outreach:** identify 5 government-linked entities via LinkedIn and warm intro requests. Book discovery calls.

Target: $9K revenue (workshop) + 3-4 Bureau retainers signed

M2

MONTH 2 — SCALE

From 4 clients to 6. Close the enterprise deal.

- → **Continue LinkedIn outreach** — 30 new outreaches per day. Focus on warm leads from workshop attendees and referrals.
- → **Enterprise discovery calls:** present DPS Bureau as "Content Infrastructure" not "production service" — for Saudi entities, framing it as infrastructure increases budget approval rate
- → **Case study content:** publish results from Month 1 clients on LinkedIn — episode count, deliverables, turnaround time. Proof-of-concept builds trust faster in Saudi than any brochure.
- → **Hire 1 Saudi-based community manager** (SAR 5,000/month) to handle client communication in Arabic and run local outreach
- → **Run second workshop** — now with social proof from Month 1 clients. Target 20 seats.

Target: $16K/month recurring + enterprise deal in final stages

M3

MONTH 3 — $20K+ LOCKED

6 Bureau clients + 1 enterprise + recurring workshops = $30K/month.

→ **6 Corporate Bureau retainers** at $2,260 average = $13,560/month

→ **1 enterprise partnership** (government-linked entity) = $6,000–10,000/month

→ **Monthly workshop** (12 seats, recurring) = $7,200/month

→ **3 studio network partners** = $1,500/month

→ **Dubai operations running in parallel** — if conflict resolved, DPS has a second revenue engine. If not, Saudi carries the business.

→ **Begin evaluation of Riyadh physical studio** — at 6+ clients, a local recording space makes business sense (not a requirement, an enhancement)

Target: $28,000–$32,000/month — $20K is a floor, not a ceiling

07 — SAUDI TARGET CLIENT LIST

Who to call first.

These are not random companies. These are organisations with confirmed massive content budgets, a mandate to produce Arabic-language content, and zero internal production capability. They are actively looking for what you offer.

— **NEOM — Communications & Marketing Division**
$500B megacity project with a global communications mandate. Produces English and Arabic content. Budget is limitless. Entry through LinkedIn to their CMO or Head of Media.

— **Saudi Tourism Authority (Visit Saudi)**
Government entity with a 9-figure marketing budget. They are actively producing podcast and video content about Saudi tourism. They need a production partner who understands the regional market.

— **Misk Foundation (Mohammed bin Salman's youth initiative)**
Runs events, programmes, and media for Saudi youth. Podcasting is central to their communications strategy. Decision-makers are young, LinkedIn-active, and open to new partnerships.

— **Saudi Entrepreneurship Authority (Riyadah)**
Government body supporting Saudi startups. Multiple podcast series in production. Would benefit from a professional production partner at corporate pricing.

- **Diriyah Company**
  Leading the development of Diriyah as a cultural and heritage destination. Active content production programme. High-budget, government-backed, seeking quality production.

- **Saudi Media Company (SMC)**
  Saudi Arabia's national media company. Produces Arabic content across multiple platforms. Partnership opportunity: DPS handles post-production for their corporate and podcast divisions.

- **PIF (Public Investment Fund) Portfolio Companies**
  PIF has 90+ portfolio companies (Lucid Motors, STC Pay, Saudi Telecom, Noon, Jarir, etc.) — every one of them has a marketing/comms budget and a mandate to produce content for Vision 2030.

- **Top 10 Saudi Law Firms + Consulting Firms (McKinsey KSA, PwC KSA, BCG Riyadh)**
  Consulting and professional services firms are the fastest-growing podcast segment globally. Their thought leadership content needs are high. Average contract: SAR 8,000–15,000/month.

08 — THE LINKEDIN ENTRY PLAYBOOK

How to reach decision-makers in Saudi within 48 hours

Saudi corporate decision-makers are highly active on LinkedIn. Cold email is dead in Saudi. LinkedIn DMs with a specific value proposition convert significantly better.

THE MESSAGE THAT OPENS DOORS (COPY-PASTE READY)

"Hi [Name] — I run Dubai Podcast Studio, Business Bay's largest podcast production network (7 studios).

We've just launched a remote production service specifically for Saudi corporates: your team records anywhere, we deliver mastered audio + 4K video + 5 branded Reels + full transcript + social content within 24 hours.

Given what [Company] is doing with its content strategy, I'd like to offer you a **free pilot episode** — no obligation, no pitch. You record a 30-minute episode, we deliver everything within 24 hours, you see the quality.

Interested? Takes 15 minutes to set up."

WHY "FREE PILOT" WORKS BETTER THAN ANY BROCHURE

In Saudi corporate culture, relationships and demonstrated results matter more than credentials. Offering a free pilot removes all friction from the first interaction. **Your**

pipeline delivers results so clearly that the pilot sells itself. Of every 5 pilots you run, 2–3 convert to monthly retainers. At SAR 8,500/retainer, a free pilot episode costing you 35 minutes of team time is worth SAR 102,000 in annual revenue per conversion.

DAILY LINKEDIN OUTREACH

50

Personalised connection requests + DMs to Saudi CMOs, Comms Directors, Marketing VPs. 10% response rate = 5 conversations/day.

CONTENT POSTS PER WEEK

3–4

Behind-the-scenes of the pipeline, client results, "why Saudi podcasting is 3 years behind" — builds credibility with every scroll.

FREE PILOTS PER MONTH

5–8

Each costs 35 min of team time. Each converts at 50–60%. Expected conversion: 3–4 new retainers per month from pilots alone.

EXPECTED MONTH 1 PIPELINE

20–30

Warm leads in active conversation after 4 weeks of consistent outreach. Close rate: 15–20% = 3–6 clients.

09 — THE MASTER STRATEGY

"Build Now, Trigger Later"

This is not a crisis plan. This is an expansion plan that doubles as a contingency. Start building it in July 2026. If conflict hits in September, you are already generating $10K+/month from Saudi before it escalates. If conflict does not hit, you have quietly built a second revenue engine.

THE STRATEGIC LOGIC

Every day you wait to enter Saudi, a competitor gets one day closer to taking the position you should own. The podcast production gap in Riyadh is the same gap Dubai had in 2019. You know exactly what happens when that gap closes — the first serious

operator wins 60% of the market. **Don't let someone else be DPS Saudi.**

IF CONFLICT HITS

Activate the Saudi engine immediately. Shift 2 team members to full-time Saudi remote operations. Sublet Dubai studios at a reduced rate to creators (cash flow during downtime). You are generating $10K+ within 45 days. Dubai operations resume when the situation normalises — with Saudi still running as an expansion.

IF CONFLICT DOES NOT HIT

You have quietly launched DPS Saudi. By October 2026, you have 4–6 Saudi retainer clients generating $9,000–13,000/month with essentially no overhead. Dubai runs at full capacity. Saudi runs in parallel. You have just doubled your revenue without opening a single new physical room.

10 — RISK MATRIX

What could go wrong and the mitigation

RISK	PROBABILITY	IMPACT	MITIGATION
Saudi clients slow to pay	Medium	Medium	Require 1-month advance payment from all retainer clients. Workshop fees are full payment upfront.
No inbound from LinkedIn outreach	Low	Medium	At 50 outreaches/day with free pilot offer, 5% response = 2.5 conversations/day minimum. The offer is too compelling to generate zero response.
Remote file upload quality issues	Low	Low	Include a "recording guide" PDF in the onboarding. Auphonic handles most audio cleanup automatically. For video, recommend specific Saudi studio partners for recording.
A Saudi competitor copies the model	Medium	Medium	Speed is your moat. Enter Saudi now, before any competitor has the pipeline built. Brand relationships in Saudi are

			extremely sticky — once you are their production partner, switching cost is high.
Dubai conflict is longer than 90 days	Very Low	High	By Month 3, Saudi revenue fully covers DPS operating costs even with Dubai at zero. Monthly studio rental in Dubai is the primary cost — negotiate a 3-month suspension clause into your next lease renewal now.
Team unwilling to shift to remote model	Low	Medium	The pipeline SOP means any team member can process Saudi files remotely. No new skills required — they already know the workflow. Remote = same workflow, different file source.

11 — THE DECISION

What to do in the next 7 days

THE 7-DAY ACTION LIST

Day 1: Update LinkedIn profile to include "Riyadh" and "Remote Content Production".
Day 2: Build the Saudi intake form in Tally. 20 minutes.
Day 3: Research 50 Saudi decision-makers on LinkedIn. Save to a spreadsheet.
Day 4: Begin outreach. 50 connection requests with personalised note.
Day 5: Contact 3 Riyadh studios about the network partner model.
Day 6: Book Riyadh trip for Week 3. Hotel + workshop venue.
Day 7: Draft workshop agenda and set ticket price at SAR 2,250.

> **"The podcasting gap in Saudi Arabia today is identical to the gap in Dubai in 2019. You already know the outcome — the first serious operator wins the market.** *The only question is whether that operator is you or someone who read this document after you did.*"
>
> DPS Marketing Strategy — Contingency & Expansion
